

Word family: **chocolate / chocolates / chocolatey**

Base word: chocolate

Part of speech: mainly **noun**, also used **attributively/adjectivally**

Related forms:

* **chocolate** (n.) — 朱古力；巧克力；朱古力食品

* **chocolates** (n.) — 一盒 / 多顆朱古力糖

* **chocolatey / chocolaty** (adj.) — 朱古力味濃的；像朱古力的

* **chocolatier** (n.) — 朱古力製造師 / 高級朱古力店家

* **chocolate-covered** — 朱古力包裹的

* **chocolate-flavoured** — 朱古力味的

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **a bar of chocolate**

* **a piece of chocolate**

* **a box of chocolates**

* **dark chocolate**

* **milk chocolate**

* **white chocolate**

* **hot chocolate**

* **chocolate cake**

* **chocolate ice cream**

* **chocolate flavour**

* **chocolate brown**

* **chocolate-covered**

* **like a box of chocolates**

Meaning in this passage

> In the past, I had given people fairly standard gifts, like books, **chocolates**, wallets, or gift cards.

Here, **chocolates** means:

individual chocolate sweets, often given in a box as a present — 朱古力糖；一盒朱古力

This is slightly different from uncountable **chocolate**, which refers to chocolate as a food/substance in general.

中文翻譯：

以前我送人的，多半都是一些很常規的禮物，例如書、**朱古力**、銀包或者禮品卡。

So here:

chocolates = 一顆顆可數的朱古力糖 / 一盒朱古力糖果

1. **chocolate (朱古力這種食物 / 材料) — 朱古力；巧克力**

This is the core uncountable sense.

Practice 1

> I love **chocolate**.

我很喜歡吃**朱古力**。

Practice 2

> The cake contains a lot of **chocolate**.

這個蛋糕用了很多**朱古力**。

Practice 3

> Melt the **chocolate** slowly.

慢慢把**朱古力**融化。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****chocolate = 由可可製成、通常帶甜味的食物或食材****

2. **a bar of chocolate — 一排 / 一塊朱古力**

Because **chocolate** as a substance is normally uncountable, we often use a unit expression.

Practice 1

> She bought **a bar of chocolate**.

她買了**一排朱古力**。

Practice 2

> I ate half a **bar of chocolate**.

我吃了半**排朱古力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a bar of chocolate = 製成長方形或塊狀、可分成小格食用的一排朱古力

3. **a piece of chocolate** — 一塊 / 一小件朱古力

Practice 1

> Would you like **a piece of chocolate**?

你想吃**一塊朱古力**嗎？

Practice 2

> She gave me a small **piece of chocolate**.

她給了我一小**塊朱古力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a piece of chocolate = 從較大份朱古力中取出的一小塊

4. **a chocolate / chocolates** (朱古力糖) — 一顆朱古力糖；朱古力糖

This is the exact countable sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — passage-related

> I sometimes gave people **chocolates** as gifts.

我有時會送**朱古力糖**給別人做禮物。

Practice 2

> She offered me **a chocolate** from the box.

她從盒裏拿了一**顆朱古力糖**給我。

Practice 3

> He bought a box of **chocolates** for his mother.

他買了一盒**朱古力**送給媽媽。

MCQ-ready definition:

a chocolate / chocolates = 一顆或多顆獨立製成、通常有餡或不同口味的朱古力糖

5. **a box of chocolates** — 一盒朱古力

Practice 1

> He gave her **a box of chocolates**.

他送了她**一盒朱古力**。

Practice 2

> We opened **a box of chocolates** after dinner.

晚飯後我們打開了**一盒朱古力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a box of chocolates = 裝有多顆獨立朱古力糖的盒裝禮品

6. **dark chocolate** — 黑朱古力

Practice 1

> I prefer **dark chocolate** to milk chocolate.

比起牛奶朱古力，我更喜歡**黑朱古力**。

Practice 2

> This cake is made with **dark chocolate**.

這個蛋糕用**黑朱古力**製作。

MCQ-ready definition:

dark chocolate = 可可含量較高、通常奶味較少、味道較濃或較苦的朱古力

7. **milk chocolate — 牛奶朱古力**

Practice 1

> Most children prefer **milk chocolate**.

很多小朋友較喜歡**牛奶朱古力**。

Practice 2

> The biscuit is covered in **milk chocolate**.

這塊餅乾外面裹着**牛奶朱古力**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****milk chocolate = 加入奶類成分、通常較甜和較柔和的朱古力****

8. **white chocolate — 白朱古力**

Practice 1

> She decorated the cake with **white chocolate**.

她用**白朱古力**裝飾蛋糕。

Practice 2

> **White chocolate** has a very sweet flavour.

****白朱古力**味道很甜。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****white chocolate = 主要以可可脂、糖及奶類成分製成、顏色較淺的朱古力產品****

9. **hot chocolate — 熱朱古力；熱可可飲品**

A lexicalized drink sense.

Practice 1

> I ordered a **hot chocolate**.

我點了一杯**熱朱古力**。

Practice 2

> She drank **hot chocolate** before bed.

她睡前喝了**熱朱古力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

hot chocolate = 以朱古力或可可製成的熱甜飲品

10. **a hot chocolate** — 一杯**熱朱古力**

Countability changes here because it refers to one serving/drink.

Practice 1

> Can I have **a hot chocolate**, please?

請給我**一杯熱朱古力**。

Practice 2

> We ordered two **hot chocolates**.

我們點了兩**杯熱朱古力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a hot chocolate = 一杯**熱朱古力飲品**

11. **chocolate cake / chocolate ice cream** — 朱古力蛋糕 / 朱古力雪糕

Here **chocolate** works attributively to describe flavour or ingredient.

Practice 1

> She made a **chocolate cake**.

她做了一個**朱古力蛋糕**。

Practice 2

> My favourite flavour is **chocolate ice cream**.

我最喜歡的口味是**朱古力雪糕**。

MCQ-ready definition:

chocolate + food noun = 含朱古力、以朱古力為主要味道或材料的食品

12. **chocolate flavour / chocolate-flavoured — 朱古力味**

Practice 1

> This drink has a strong **chocolate flavour**.

這款飲品有很濃的**朱古力味**。

Practice 2

> She bought **chocolate-flavoured milk**.

她買了**朱古力味牛奶**。

MCQ-ready definition:

chocolate-flavoured = tasting like chocolate, whether or not chocolate is the main ingredient

13. **chocolate-covered — 朱古力包裹的**

Practice 1

> We bought **chocolate-covered strawberries**.

我們買了**朱古力士多啤梨**。

Practice 2

> He likes **chocolate-covered biscuits**.

他喜歡吃**朱古力包裹的餅乾**。

MCQ-ready definition:

chocolate-covered X = 外層被朱古力包住或蘸上朱古力的 X

14. **chocolate (顏色：朱古力啡) — 深啡色；朱古力色**

A distinct adjective/noun colour sense.

Practice 1

> She wore a **chocolate-brown coat**.

她穿了一件**朱古力啡色外套**。

Practice 2

> The sofa is a deep **chocolate colour**.

張梳化是深**朱古力啡色**。

MCQ-ready definition:

chocolate = a rich dark brown colour resembling chocolate

中文：

像朱古力一樣的濃深啡色

15. **chocolate brown — 朱古力啡**

Practice 1

> The walls were painted **chocolate brown**.

牆身髹成**朱古力啡色**。

Practice 2

> She chose a **chocolate-brown** leather bag.

她選了一個**朱古力啡色**皮袋。

MCQ-ready definition:

chocolate brown = 深而溫暖、像朱古力的啡色

16. **chocolatey / chocolaty — 朱古力味濃的**

Practice 1

> The dessert is rich and **chocolatey**.

這款甜品**朱古力味很濃**。

Practice 2

> I like a really **chocolatey** cake.

我喜歡**朱古力味很重**的蛋糕。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****chocolatey = having a strong chocolate taste, smell, or quality****

中文：

****具有濃厚朱古力味、香氣或質感的****

17. **chocolatier — 朱古力製造師；高級朱古力店家**

Practice 1

> The **chocolatier** makes everything by hand.

那位**朱古力製作師**所有產品都以人手製作。

Practice 2

> We visited a famous Belgian **chocolatier**.

我們參觀了一間著名的比利時**朱古力店 / 朱古力品牌**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****chocolatier = 專門製作或售賣高級朱古力的人、店舖或公司****

18. **like a box of chocolates — 像一盒朱古力一樣充滿未知選擇**

This appears in the famous expression:

> Life is like a box of chocolates...

The broader figurative idea is:

you do not know exactly what you will get until you choose or experience it

For copyright reasons, we don't need the full famous quotation.

Practice 1

> Choosing from those jobs felt **like a box of chocolates**—each one was different.

在那些工作之間選擇，就像面對**一盒不同口味的朱古力**，每個都不一樣。

Practice 2

> The collection is **like a box of chocolates**: every story has a different flavour.

這個作品集就像**一盒朱古力**：每個故事都有不同風格。

MCQ-ready definition:

like a box of chocolates = figuratively, full of varied and somewhat unpredictable possibilities

Important distinction 1: **chocolate uncountable vs a chocolate countable**

This is the most important grammar point.

Uncountable

> I like **chocolate**.

我喜歡朱古力。

This means the food/material generally.

Countable

> I ate **a chocolate**.

我吃了一顆朱古力糖。

So:

* **chocolate** = 朱古力這種食物
* **a chocolate** = 一顆朱古力糖
* **chocolates** = 多顆朱古力糖

Your passage uses the third.

Important distinction 2: **chocolate vs chocolates**

chocolate

substance/general food

> She bought some chocolate.

她買了一些朱古力。

chocolates

individual sweets, often boxed

> She bought some chocolates.

她買了幾顆 / 一盒朱古力糖。

This difference matters directly in your passage.

Important distinction 3: **chocolate vs cocoa / cacao**

cacao

usually refers to the plant, beans, or less-processed source material.

cocoa

often refers to cocoa powder or cocoa-based drink/product.

chocolate

the finished food/product made using cocoa ingredients.

So:

> cocoa powder

可可粉

> chocolate bar

朱古力條 / 排

They are related but not interchangeable.

Important distinction 4: **hot chocolate vs cocoa**

In everyday usage they can overlap.

hot chocolate

often suggests a richer drink made with chocolate or cocoa plus milk/water.

hot cocoa

often emphasizes cocoa powder.

But recipes and regional usage vary.

Important distinction 5: **chocolate flavour vs actual chocolate**

Something can be:

> chocolate-flavoured

without containing a large amount of real chocolate.

So **flavour** describes taste, not necessarily ingredient composition.

Important distinction 6: **dark chocolate vs bitter**

dark chocolate

a type/category of chocolate.

bitter

a taste description.

Dark chocolate may taste more bitter, but **dark** does not simply mean “bitter.”

Important distinction 7: **white chocolate vs milk chocolate**

white chocolate

light-coloured; based largely on cocoa butter, sugar, and milk ingredients.

milk chocolate

contains cocoa solids plus milk ingredients.

They are different product categories.

Important distinction 8: **chocolate = food vs chocolate = colour**

Food

> I bought chocolate.

我買了朱古力。

Colour

> a chocolate-brown bag

朱古力啡色袋

The colour sense is metaphorically based on the typical appearance of chocolate.

Important distinction 9: **chocolate cake vs cake with chocolate on it**

chocolate cake

the cake itself is chocolate-flavoured.

cake with chocolate on it

may simply have chocolate topping/coating.

This is a useful compound distinction.

Important distinction 10: **a box of chocolates vs chocolate box**

a box of chocolates

a box containing chocolates.

chocolate box

can mean:

* a box designed for chocolates

* figuratively, something picturesque and overly pretty, especially in BrE: **chocolate-box village/scenery**

19. **chocolate-box (漂亮得像明信片般 ; 過分精緻的) — 如畫的 ; 過分甜美精緻的**

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> They stayed in a **chocolate-box village**.

他們住在一條**如畫般漂亮的小村莊**。

Practice 2

> The cottage has a **chocolate-box appearance**.

那間小屋有一種**漂亮得像童話明信片般的外觀**。

MCQ-ready definition:

chocolate-box = very pretty and picturesque, sometimes to the point of seeming unreal or overly idealized

中文 :

****漂亮得像禮盒圖畫一樣，有時帶有過分理想化的意味****

Important distinction 11: ****chocolate-box is not literally about a box of chocolate****

This is a figurative adjective.

> a chocolate-box village

does ****not**** mean:

> 一條製造朱古力盒的村莊

It means:

**風景漂亮、精緻、像傳統朱古力禮盒上的畫一樣**

Family-extension note

****Chocolate**** has three main learner-relevant branches:

1. **food/substance**

- * chocolate
- * bar of chocolate
- * dark chocolate
- * milk chocolate

2. **individual confection**

- * a chocolate
- * chocolates
- * box of chocolates

3. **flavour/colour description**

- * chocolate cake
- * chocolate-flavoured
- * chocolate brown

Useful extensions include:

4. **derivatives**

* chocolatey

* chocolatier

5. **figurative compound**

* chocolate-box village

The biggest grammar point is the countability shift:

chocolate = uncountable food

a chocolate / chocolates = individual sweets

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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chocolate	朱古力	food/substance	
a bar of chocolate	一排朱古力	unit of chocolate	
a piece of chocolate	一塊朱古力	small portion	
a chocolate	一顆朱古力糖	individual sweet	
chocolates	朱古力糖	multiple sweets	
a box of chocolates	一盒朱古力	gift box	
dark chocolate	黑朱古力	high-cocoa variety	
milk chocolate	牛奶朱古力	milk-based variety	
white chocolate	白朱古力	pale cocoa-butter product	
hot chocolate	熱朱古力	drink	
a hot chocolate	一杯熱朱古力	one serving	
chocolate cake	朱古力蛋糕	chocolate-flavoured food	
chocolate-flavoured	朱古力味的	flavour	
chocolate-covered	朱古力包裹的	coating	
chocolate brown	朱古力啡	colour	
chocolatey	朱古力味濃的	strong chocolate quality	
chocolatier	朱古力製作師 / 店家	specialist maker	
chocolate-box	如畫般漂亮的	picturesque, idealized	

For your original sentence

> In the past, I had given people fairly standard gifts, like books, **chocolates**, wallets, or gift cards.

Here:

chocolates = 一顆顆獨立的朱古力糖，通常是一盒用來送禮的朱古力

This is **countable plural**, not the general uncountable food sense.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 以前我送人的，多半都是一些很常規的禮物，例如書、**朱古力**、銀包或者禮品卡。

Chinese does not need to mark the countability distinction explicitly, but in English it matters:

> **some chocolate** = 一些朱古力這種食物

> **some chocolates** = 幾顆 / 一盒朱古力糖

For your passage, **chocolates** strongly suggests the familiar **boxed-gift confection** sense.